

NANDI ZHANG

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EDUCATION

University of Rochester
PhD in Computer Science
Advisor: Professor Yukang Yan

Sept. 2025 -

University of Calgary
MSc in Computer Science (Thesis-based)
Advisor: Professor Ryo Suzuki

Sept. 2023 - Aug. 2025

Hong Kong University of Science and Technology
BSc in Data Science and Technology
Advisor: Professor Xiaojuan Ma

Sept. 2018 - Aug. 2022

RESEARCH INTEREST

My research explores how humans perceive, interpret, and act within **Mixed Reality** and **Human-Robot Interaction** contexts. I aim to build scientific models that both explain and shape human perception and behavior.

PUBLICATION

- [1] **Nandi Zhang**, Yukang Yan, and Ryo Suzuki. From Following to Understanding: Investigating the Role of Reflective Prompts in AR-Guided Tasks to Promote Task Understanding. (**CHI'25**)
- [2] Hanfang Lyu, Xiaoyu Wang, **Nandi Zhang**, Shuai Ma, Qian Zhu, Yuhao Luo, Fu-Gee Tsung, and Xiaojuan Ma. Signaling Human Intentions to Service Robots: Understanding the Use of Social Cues during In-Person Conversations. (**CHI'25**)
Honorable Mention
- [3] Aditya Gunturu, Shivesh Singh Jadon, **Nandi Zhang**, Morteza Faraji, Jarin Thundathil, Tafreed Ahmad, Wesley Willett, and Ryo Suzuki. RealitySummary: Exploring On-Demand Mixed Reality Text Summarization and Question Answering using Large Language Models. (**SUI'25**)
- [4] **Nandi Zhang**, Nelson Wong. A Pedagogical Model for Soft-Skill Education in Computer Science: Pass/Fail Grading with Public In-Class Feedback. (**WCCCE'25**)
- [5] Aditya Gunturu, Yi Wen, **Nandi Zhang**, Jarin Thundathil, Rubaiat Habib Kazi, and Ryo Suzuki. Augmented Physics: A Machine Learning-Powered Tool for Creating Interactive Physics Simulations from Static Diagrams. *In Proceedings of the Annual ACM Symposium on User Interface Software and Technology*. 2024. (**UIST'24**)
Best Paper Award
- [6] Peixuan Xiong, Yukai Zhang, **Nandi Zhang**, Shihan Fu, Xin Li, Yadan Zheng, Jinni Zhou, Xiquan Hu, and Mingming Fan. To Reach the Unreachable: Exploring the Potential of VR Hand Redirection for Upper Limb Rehabilitation. *In Proceedings of the CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems*. 2024. (**CHI'24**)

WORKING EXPERIENCE

SenseTime Group Inc.

Jan 2021 - Jan 2022

Research Intern

Contributed to diverse machine learning projects, addressing neural collapse in transfer learning and developing a comprehensive vision model training framework. Explored few-shot distillation techniques and implemented language models, including BERT and GPT-2. Pre-trained large-scale visio-linguistic models and worked on reinforcement learning systems like AlphaZero.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

DATA 201: Thinking with Data

Fall 2023

Teaching Assistant

Instructor: Professor Nelson Wong

Department of Computer Science, University of Calgary

DATA 201: Thinking with Data

Winter 2024 & Fall 2024

Head Teaching Assistant

Instructor: Professor Nelson Wong

Department of Computer Science, University of Calgary

SCIE 398: Communication for Computer Science

Fall 2024

Course Development Assistant

Instructor: Professor Nelson Wong

Department of Computer Science, University of Calgary

CPSC 233: Introduction to CS for CS Majors II

Fall 2024

Teaching Assistant

Instructor: Professor Jonathan Hudson

Department of Computer Science, University of Calgary

SERVICE

Paper Review

CHI 2026

CHI 2025

CSCW 2025

ISMAR 2025

Student Volunteer

CHI 2024

SKILLS

Programming Languages and Frameworks: Python (Proficient), C# (Proficient), Pytorch (Proficient), C++ (Proficient), Swift (Proficient), R (Familiar), Java (Familiar), JavaScript (Familiar), SQL and NoSQL (Familiar)

Web Technologies: React (Proficient)

Software and Tools: Unity (Proficient), Tableau (Proficient), Qualtrics (Proficient), OpenRefine (Proficient), Matlab (Familiar)

Languages: English (Fluent), Mandarin (Native)